Brightwave Technologies

Employee Policy Handbook
Version 3.2 | Effective January 1, 2026 | Fictional sample document

1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook explains the policies that apply to all full-time employees of Brightwave Technologies. It covers working hours, leave, remote work, expense reimbursement, conduct, information security and learning support. Where a local law gives you a greater entitlement than this handbook, the law applies. Questions about this handbook should be sent to hr-help@brightwave.example.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard work week is 40 hours. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time, Monday to Friday. Employees may schedule the remaining hours flexibly with manager agreement. All employees must be reachable on Slack during core hours.

3. Leave Policy

3.1 Annual leave. Full-time employees receive 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accruing at 2 days per month. Up to 10 unused days may be carried forward into the next year; any days above 10 expire on March 31. Leave of more than 3 consecutive days must be requested at least 5 business days in advance and approved by your manager.

3.2 Sick leave. Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for any absence longer than 2 consecutive days.

3.3 Parental leave. The primary caregiver is entitled to 26 weeks of fully paid leave and the secondary caregiver to 8 weeks of fully paid leave. Leave may be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption.

3.4 Bereavement leave. Employees may take 5 days of paid leave on the death of an immediate family member and 3 days for other close relatives.

3.5 Public holidays. The company observes 12 public holidays per year. The calendar is published each December for the following year.

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

Brightwave operates a hybrid model.

- Employees must work from the office at least 3 days per week.
- Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a Vice President.
- A one-time home-office stipend of $500 and a monthly internet allowance of $50 are provided to approved remote and hybrid employees.
- Working from another country is permitted for up to 30 days per year and requires prior approval from both HR and IT Security.

5. Expense Reimbursement

Submit expense claims through the ExpensePortal within 30 days of the expense. Approved claims are reimbursed within 10 business days.

Expense type	Limit or rule
Meals during business travel	$60 per day
Hotel	Up to $200 per night
Flights under 6 hours	Economy class
Flights over 6 hours	Premium economy allowed
Receipts	Required for any expense over $25

Approval thresholds. Expenses over $500 need manager approval. Expenses over $2,500 additionally need Finance approval.

6. Code of Conduct

- Employees must treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect. Harassment and discrimination are not tolerated.
- Gifts from vendors or customers must not exceed $75 in value, and anything above that must be declined or reported to Compliance.
- Any potential conflict of interest must be disclosed to your manager and Compliance in writing.
- Concerns can be raised confidentially through the Ethics Hotline at 1-800-555-0142 or by email to ethics@brightwave.example. Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is prohibited.

7. Information Security

- Passwords must be at least 14 characters long, and multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory on all company accounts.
- All company laptops use full-disk encryption. Do not disable it.
- A lost or stolen device must be reported to security@brightwave.example within 2 hours of discovery.
- Confidential data must never be stored in personal cloud storage or sent to personal email accounts.
- Data is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Restricted data may be shared only with named individuals approved by the data owner.

8. Performance and Learning

Annual performance reviews take place in December. Each employee has a personal learning budget of $1,200 per year for courses, books and conferences, subject to manager approval. Unused budget does not roll over.

9. Probation and Notice Period

New employees serve a 6-month probation period. After probation, either party must give 60 days written notice to end employment. During probation the notice period is 30 days.

This is a fictional document created for demonstration purposes. Brightwave Technologies does not exist.